

■ B.7.7 Setting Up Textual Output

Output from *Mathematica* calculations is usually written to the special file named "stdout". You can specify various properties of the output you want by setting different options for the file "stdout".

<code>ResetMedium[options]</code>	reset the specified options for the standard output from <i>Mathematica</i>
<code>ResetMedium[PageWidth->n]</code>	set up output for a text width of n characters

Setting text output options.

<code>FormatType</code>	<code>OutputForm</code>	default format for printing expressions
<code>PageHeight</code>	22	number of lines per page
<code>PageWidth</code>	78	number of character widths per line
<code>TextRendering</code>	Plain	type of text output
<code>TotalHeight</code>	Infinity	maximum number of lines for a single expression
<code>TotalWidth</code>	Infinity	maximum number of character widths for a single expression

Some options for text output.

Particularly when you first start *Mathematica*, you will often want to set `PageWidth` to correspond to the actual width of the text area available for *Mathematica* output. You can typically do this by running an external program that calls `stty` and so on, and using the result as the value of `PageWidth`.

<code>Format[In] := nameIn</code>	specify alternative input prompts
<code>Format[Out] := nameOut</code>	specify alternative output labels
<code>Format[Continuation[n_]] := form</code>	specify continuation line marks
<code>\$PrePrint := function</code>	specify a function to apply to every output expression

Some characteristics of text output that you can specify.

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Particularly if you run the kernel of *Mathematica* on a different computer than you run the front end, you may find it convenient to set up prompts and output labels that tell you what computer is being used.

<code>Continuation[n]</code>	the object whose print form is given at the beginning of the n^{th} line in multiline output (default: <code>></code>)
<code>Indent[d]</code>	the object whose print form gives the indentation to be used on a line that begins with a depth d subexpression (default: d spaces)
<code>LineBreak[n]</code>	the object whose print form is given between the n^{th} and $(n+1)^{\text{th}}$ line in multiline output (default: a blank line)
<code>Skeleton[n]</code>	the object whose print form is given in place of n omitted elements in Short output (default: <code><<n>></code>)
<code>StringBreak[n]</code>	the object whose print form is given at the end of the n^{th} part of a string that is broken onto several lines (default: <code>\</code>)
<code>StringSkeleton[n]</code>	the object whose print form is given in place of n omitted characters in Short output of a string (default: <code>..</code>)

Other objects whose print forms can be defined.